

623



LIMITED EDITION



A GLOSSARY OF TYPOGRAPHIC TERMS



A Glossary of Typographic Terms

Raine Cerankosky
DESIGNER

No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means, electronic, mechanical, photocopying, recording, scanning, or otherwise without either the prior written permission of the Publisher, or authorization through payment of the appropriate per-copy fee. Requests to the Publisher for permission should be addressed to NSCAD University Press,

5163 Duke Street, Halifax, Nova Scotia, Canada B3J 3J6
or consult the web-site: www.nscad.ca

ISBN-13: 978-0-471-72016-4 1.
A Glossary of Typographic Terms. I.

Rod McDonald
AUTHOR

II. Title. TS195.4.K652006 658.5'64--dc22

Printed in Canada 10 9 8 7 6 5 4 3 2 1 2 0 0 6 0 0 4 5 3 9
Copyright © 2024 by NSCAD University Press, Halifax, Nova Scotia



Author's Alterations

Changes to the original manuscript copy made by the author or designer that affect the content, final form or both. Distinguished from any corrections or changes resulting from errors made by the designer or the typographer.

Alignment

1. An imaginary horizontal line at the top or bottom of letters and characters to which they visually align.
2. The positioning of text within the text block or frame. Alignment can be flush left, flush right, justified, or centered. Flush left and flush right are sometimes referred to as left justified and right justified.

Ascender

The part of the lowercase letters b, d, f, h, k, l and t that extends above the x-height, or above the letter x.

Author's Proof

Typeset proof sent to the author for corrections, changes or final approval.

Bad Break

1. Any break in the text that violates an established typographic rule.
2. An undesirable situation at the end of typeset lines, such as improper hyphenation or an unwanted word division.

Agate Type

An old measurement size of approximately 5½ points. In newspaper advertising fourteen agate lines made one inch of matter. Agate Lines were a unit of measurement for newspaper advertising space.

Alphabet Length

The length, in points of the lowercase letterforms of the alphabet (a - z) of a particular size and style of typeface.

Ampersand

Name of the sign (&) used for 'and', derived from the Latin 'et'.

Asterisk

The (*) symbol indicates unnumbered references or footnotes. From the Greek Asterikos ('little Star').



Baseline

A horizontal, imaginary line on which the Latin typeset characters 'sit' or 'rest'. Leading, or line spacing, is measured from baseline to baseline.

Bad Copy

Any manuscript that is indistinct, illegible, poorly specified, improperly edited, or otherwise considered unsatisfactory.

Boldface (BF)

A typeface with a heavier appearance than its regular weight companion but containing the same design characteristics, e.g. Some publishing applications allow you to apply a computer-generated, or fake, bold style to a regular weight font. Using this technique is not recommended.

Bounce

Visually unaligned letters. Considered a defect in typesetting unless done intentionally for effect.

Box In

To enclose or encompass matter with a border of rules or ornaments.

Break

The place for ending or dividing a line of type.

Breve

Accent mark (˘) used to indicate the short sound of the vowel over which it is positioned.

Brochure

A pamphlet folded or bound in the form of a booklet.

Byline

The credit line for an author in publications.

Body

1. The main text usually comprised of paragraphs that make up the bulk of the content in a manuscript or document.
2. 'Body size' (measured in points) is the dimension corresponding to the overall height of a letter and is the same for all characters in that typeface.

Border

A plain or ornamental frame placed around the type or art.

Bowl

The enclosed portion of the bottom half of an old style 'g'.

Brackets

Character for enclosing material (thus). Typographically, () are called parentheses (or parens). [] are called 'square brackets'.

Break in Copy

A term meaning there is a missing copy

Break Line

A short line, particularly at the end of a paragraph.

Bullets

Large dots (•) typically used in the listing of items placed at the left of items to show they are individual, but related, items.



Cap Height

The height of a capital letter measured from the baseline to the top of the letter. This may or may not be the same as the height of ascenders. Not to be confused with x-height.

Caps and Small Caps (C & SC)

Two sizes of capitals made on the same body size, the first being normal. Small caps are usually closer in size to the lowercase characters in the font.

Cedilla

An accent mark (ç) positioned under the letter c. In most Romance languages, it denotes an s sound, as in façade.

Cent Mark

The (¢) character used as an abbreviation for cents. Seldom used today except in retail advertising.

Chapter Heading

This is the number and title of a chapter in a book.

Character

1. A letter, numeral, symbol, or mark of punctuation.
2. A combination of bits (one byte) that represents a letter, numeral, etc. Within the context of modern computer operating systems, it is often defined as a code with a meaning attached to it. For example, the decimal character code 97 represents the letter 'a'. Also see character encoding, keyboard layout, OpenType, Unicode.

Capital

Capital or uppercase character. Cap, abbreviation for capital, always refers to capital, or uppercase letters.

Caption

This is the descriptive text accompanying an illustration, chart, picture or table, etc. Sometimes referred to as a legend.

Caret

A symbol (^) used by proofreaders to mark the point at which an insertion is to be made.

Centering

To position type, or art, equidistant from two points either vertically, horizontally or both.

Character Mapping

See character encoding.

Character Encoding

A table in a font or a computer operating system that maps character codes to glyphs in a font. Most operating systems are moving from a platform-specific single-byte encoding system that limited the number of possible glyphs in a font to 256 to a new two-byte international encoding standard called Unicode. Unicode allows for the inclusion of up to 65,000 glyphs in a single font. Adobe's OpenType fonts are based on Unicode. Also see character, glyph, keyboard layout, Unicode.

Character Set

A complete set of letters, numbers, and other special characters of a particular typeface style. The terms Character Set, Font and Character Complement are synonymous. The selection and quantity of characters will vary from one manufacturer to another.

Circumflex

Diacritical mark (^) positioned above its base character, e.g.

Close Matter

Type set 'solid' with no points of additional space between lines.

Close Up

To remove excess spacing between characters, words, lines or paragraphs.

Closing Quote

Mark of punctuation denoting the ending of a quotation. The two forms are double closing quote (") and single closing quote (').

Color

See Typographic Color.

Compound Word

Words formed by a combination of two or more words, e.g. sailboat, mother-in-law.

Comprehensive

A layout, often used in advertising to present the initial concept to the client, with any illustrations and lettering done almost as completely as the finished work. Often simply called a 'comp'.

Contrast

A subjective feeling that graphic elements (such as fonts) are different but work together well. This gives a feeling of variety without losing harmony. Within a particular font, contrast also refers to the differences of stroke thicknesses that make up the characters. For example, *Myriad* has low contrast and *Bodoni* has high contrast.

Clean Proof

This is a typeset proof in which all the author's alterations and typesetter's errors have been corrected.

Close Spacing

This is tight spacing between characters and words, the amount of which can vary from one typographer to another and is considered a question of subjective aesthetics.

Colophon

1. In books, particularly: a statement recording the names of the designer, photographer, illustrator, typographer and printer, the kind of typefaces and paper used, and any other information concerning the production of the book.
2. The logo or trade emblem of a printer or publisher.

Compose

Typesetting of a text in proper order and form. This was work done by a typesetter.

Compositor

This was a term for the person who sets type or inputs typesetting copy by means of a keyboard.

Condensed

A narrower version of a font, used to fit a maximum number of characters into a given space.



Copy

1. Handwritten, typewritten or printed words, manuscript or design given to the typographer for setting.
2. A single specimen of a finished work.
3. To reproduce data in a new or different location or other destination, leaving the source data unchanged.

Copyfitting

Calculating type specifications (size, leading, measure, etc.) to make a certain amount of copy fit within a predefined amount of space.

Correct

To mark errors in a proof or to remedy any faults in typeset material.

Counter

The white space found inside of a closed part of a letter such as the 'o, e, a, p', etc.

Cross Head

This is a heading that runs across one or more columns. Usually located at the top of the page.

Cross-Reference

1. A notation or direction to the reader of an index, or similar material, to refer elsewhere for the information sought.
2. A reference in the text of a book to some other part of the book (figure, table, map, etc.).

Copyright Page

Found on the reverse of the title page of a book and bearing the copyright (©) notice, publisher's imprint, ISBN (International Standard Book Number) and other necessary information.

Correction

The notation on a proof, or the change required to ensure the setting conforms to the original data and/or instructions.

Crop Marks

1. Lines to indicate where a photograph or illustration should be trimmed.
2. Lines to indicate the cutting trim of a printed piece.

Dagger

The symbol (†) used as a reference mark. If placed in front of a person's name it means they have recently died.

Dead

Typeset matter that is no longer needed.

Decorative Typeface

These are appearance-based or usage-based category of typefaces. Decorative typefaces are often ornate and attention-grabbing. In her book *The Non-Designer's Design Book*, Robin Williams has provided a useful working definition of a decorative typeface: "...if the thought of reading an entire book in that typeface makes you want to throw up, you can probably put it in the decorative pot."

Diacritical Mark

A mark placed above, below, alongside, or through an alphabetic character, usually to alter its pronunciation, tone, or stress. Accents are diacritical marks, although not all diacritical marks are accents the terms are often used interchangeably.

Dirty Proof

A proof containing typographical errors or having an image quality below desired standards.

Display Type

Typefaces designed and used primarily for large headlines in contrast to text sizes. This is another category of typefaces with characteristics similar to decorative typefaces. In some typeface families, a typeface is categorized as a display typeface when it has been specifically designed for larger sizes (usually over 24 points) with thinner strokes, more delicate serifs, etc.

Dash

A typographical character or sign in the form of a horizontal stroke. Usually an Em (—) and En (–) widths. Em dashes are used to set off parenthetical expressions or to show a sudden departure or shift in thought. En dashes are used in numeric work to indicate range. A dash of three-quarter em width is frequently used in advertising typography as a substitute for the em dash.

Depth

A vertical measurement, as in the depth of a page, a figure, or a table.

Descender

These are the part of the letters j, g, p, q, and y that drops below the baseline. In some typefaces, the uppercase J and Q also descend below the baseline.

Dieresis or Diaeresis

The accent mark (¨) positioned over the second of two adjoining vowels to indicate a distinct pronunciation. In German it is called 'umlaut'.

Dingbat

A decorative typographic character, e.g. ¶.

Diphthong

These are a pair of letters forming an unsegmentable sound. Including the combination of two vowels forming one character, i.e. Æ, æ, Œ, œ, etc. Not to be confused with Ligatures.



Distortion

This is the modification of a typeface in order to achieve a condensed, expanded or oblique appearance. Perspectives and arcs in the setting of letterforms or words may also be classified as such.

Dot Leaders

Evenly spaced dots set on the baseline to lead the eye between typographic elements on a line, as between the chapter title and page number in a table of contents. Other typographic characters may be used as leaders, such as the hyphen (hyphen leaders) or the dash (dash leaders).

dpi

This is an abbreviation for dots per inch. Refers to the resolution at which a device, such as a monitor or printer, can display text and graphics. Monitors are usually 72 to 120 dpi or less, and laser printers are usually dpi or higher. An image printed on a laser printer looks sharper than the same image on a monitor.

Drop Cap or Drop Initial

A design treatment in which the first capital letter of a paragraph is set in a larger point size and aligned with the top of the first line. This method is used to indicate the start of a new section of text, such as a chapter. Also see Raised Cap.

Division of Words

The hyphenation or 'breaking' of words at the ends of lines in order to make lines of equal length and to avoid as much as possible any unequal spacing between words in justified settings.

Double Prime

The mark follows a number and indicates a distance amount of 'inches'. The double prime mark is often used in place of the curly quotations in typewritten material, emails, on the Web, etc. They are straight, upright tick marks—in some fonts may be tapered or shaped like an upside down teardrops, e.g. ". When the double prime mark is used as open and closing quotation marks in typeset material, it is often considered a sign of amateur or sloppy typography. Also see Prime.

Drop Folio

The page number printed at the bottom, or foot, of a page.

Dummy

This is a made-up sample of a projected book, pamphlet, advertisement or other material that shows the final appearance and size of the completed work.

Ear

Is the small protrusion on the top right portion of an oldstyle 'g' that looks like a small ear.

Em, Em Space, Em Quad

These are common units of measurement in typography. An em is traditionally defined as the width of the uppercase M in the current face and point size. It is more properly defined as simply the current point size. For example, in 16 point type, one em is a distance of 16 points.

Embossed Finish

Paper with a mechanically raised or depressed surface often resembling wood, cloth, leather or other patterns.

Encoding

See Character Encoding.

End Matter

The material printed at the end of a book, after the text proper, including appendixes, bibliographies, glossaries, indexes, etc. Also called 'back matter' or 'reference matter'.

Ellipsis

A punctuation character consisting of three dots, or periods, in set in a row. It indicates that a word or phrase has been omitted.

Em Dash

A dash one em in length. (—) An em being defined as the square of the body.

En Dash

A dash one en in length. (–) An en being defined as half the square of the body. An en dash can be used to indicate a range of values, e.g. 6–11

Expert Set,

Expert Collection

A font that has a more refined, or expanded, set of typographic characters than regular fonts. Expert sets may contain oldstyle figures, ligatures, small capitals, embellishments, fractions, or other unique characters. Also see OpenType.



Face

A typeface or type style. Short for typeface. See Typeface.

Figures

Typographers term for numerals, e.g. 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 0.

Flush

In printing the term 'flush'—level, even or on the same plane—designates the absence of indentation. Flush-left lines of type begin at the left margin and end at varying points. The term 'flush right' indicates that the type aligns on the right margin and the left side varies. Text set both flush left and flush right is referred to as 'justified'. Flush left is synonymous with 'ragged right', a common terminology, and flush right is also referred to as 'ragged left'.

Font

1. One weight, width, and style of a typeface: **Optima Bold** and Helvetica Light Condensed are examples of fonts. Before digital type, a font usually referred to a specific point size of a particular style of a typeface. For example, 48-point **Helvetica Bold** would have been considered a font.
2. The specific physical device or devices used to store these characters—disc, film grid, etc. Fonts are commonly grouped into 'families' in which each member font represents a different treatment of the same basic design—roman, italic, bold, etc.
3. The complete set of letters, numbers, punctuation marks, special characters, etc. of a typeface.

Family

A collection of typefaces that were designed and intended to be used together. For example, the Granville family consists of variations of typefaces within the same design style such as: Granville Roman, *Granville Italic*. Each of the style and weight combinations is referred to as a font or typeface.

Folio

A page number, usually placed at the outside of the running head at the top of a page. If placed at the bottom of a page, the number is a 'drop folio'. A folio counted in numbering pages but not printed (as on the title page) is a 'blind folio'. Any folio printed is called a 'expressed folio'.

Follow Copy

An instruction to the typesetter to set the type exactly like the copy in every detail. In the past typesetting apprentices were told to "Follow the copy, even if it goes out the window!"

Font Family

See Family

Foreword

A short introductory piece, usually written by someone other than the author, which is part of the preliminaries or front matter of a book.

Format

The overall basic specifications of a printed piece—its size, shape, type styles, etc.

Front Matter

The preliminaries of a book such as the title page, copyright page, table of contents, etc.



Galley

Typesetting material for proofreading purposes and not made up into its final form.

Glyph

In the context of modern computer operating systems, glyph is often defined as a shape in a font that is used to represent a character code on screen or paper. The most common example of a glyph is a letter in a specific font, but the symbols and shapes in a font like ITC Zapf Dingbats® are also glyphs. Also see character, character encoding, keyboard layout.

Gutters

The margins of space located between adjacent columns within a page or table, or between the inside margin and the binding.

Full Measure

The widest possible measure of a column or page.

Gatefold

A foldout leaf or page in a book or magazine, etc.

Grave

An accent mark (`) positioned above its base character, e.g. è .

Guide Lines

1. Copy placed by the typographer on a proof (usually at the top) containing identification information such as job title, customer name, etc.
2. Lines to guide operations in the assembly of type and illustrations on screen.



Heading

1. **Head, Headline:** A general term referring to type set apart from a section of the text and serving as a title or descriptive copy to what follows.
2. **Box Heading:** similar to a cut-in head but has a rule around it; or, a head for a column in a ruled table.
3. **Centered Head:** a headline placed equidistant from both margins of the page or column.
4. **Chapter Heading:** consists of the chapter title and number sometimes with a brief quotation or description. In multi-author volumes the author's name is part of the chapter headings.
5. **Cut-in Head:** a head placed in a box of white space cut into the side of the typeset page. It is usually set in a type different from that of the text and placed under the first two lines of the paragraph; also, a head cutting across the body of a table.
6. **Running Head:** a headline that is placed at the top of a page or column. Running heads are an aid to the reader and ideally reflect subdivisions of the work in the most useful way possible.
7. **Side Head:** a headline placed at the side of the page or column. It may be set as a separate line, in which case it is usually set flush with the margin of the type page, or it may run in, i.e. in a line continuous with the paragraph to which it belongs.
8. **Sub Head or Subheading:** a head of any description making a subdivision of the main head.

H & J

See Hyphenation and Justification.

Hairline

1. A very fine or delicate rule or frame, typically less than 1/2 point thick.
2. Any part of a letter that is very thin or light.

Hanging Indent

A document style in which the first line of a paragraph is aligned with the left margin, and the remaining lines are all indented an equal amount. This is an effective way to display lists of information.

Hard Copy

1. The original manuscript to be typeset.
2. The paper product images of a laserwriter or high resolution output device.

Headline

The short lines of emphasized text that introduce detail information in the body text that follows. Also the category of typefaces that are designed to work best when used as headline text.

Headline Font

A font that has been designed to look good at large point sizes for use in headlines. Headline fonts generally do not contain a complete set of characters since they do not require a full set of special symbols and punctuation.

Hints

The mathematical instructions added to digital fonts to make them sharp at all sizes and on display devices of different resolutions.

Hyphen

A mark of punctuation placed between elements of certain compound words or phrases. The hyphen is also used to divide a word between syllables when necessary to do so at the end of a line due to line length restrictions. A Hard Hyphen is a hyphen that is mandatory in the spelling of a word or phrase rather than one used for end of line word divisions, e.g. 'first-class'.



Imposition

This is the process of arranging the made-up pages of a form or signature so that, when the sheets are printed and folded, the pages will be in the proper sequence and right side up.

Indent (Indention)

Placement of a selected portion of text so that the beginning or end (or both) of the lines of the selected text does not align with the margins of the main text.

Inferior

A character, commonly a numeral, which is smaller type size than usual and sets below the baseline of the normal character. Also known as a subscript. These characters are used in mathematical setting to qualify and modify the main text, and in straight setting as reference points and distinguishing marks, e.g. ²₃ Garamond ATF

House Corrections

A term used for errors that need correcting because of mistakes made by either the designer or typesetter. Also called office corrections and in the past Printer's Errors.

Hyphenation

This is used to indicate the division of a word at the end of a line. In typesetting, whenever it is not possible to justify a line by the expansion of word spaces or by the insertion of the next complete word, the last complete word in the line is divided at an acceptable place, the hyphen inserted, and the remainder of the word moved on to the next line.

Italic

A version of a typeface which consists of oblique stems and is more cursive in nature; usually used to accent or add emphasis. The names of books, magazines or journals are set in italic, e.g. *Applied Arts*.

Initial Cap

A capital letter, larger and sometimes in a contrasting style, used for decorative purposes at the beginning of a chapter, section, etc. Sometimes drawn or engraved by lettering artists. Swash initials are florid versions of the standard italic capital letters, e.g. *Dulcinea*. Swash initials are only available in certain fonts. See Raised Cap.



Job

Any piece of work to be typeset or prepared for printing.

Justification

A block of text that has word spacing to align text on both the left and right margins. Justified text has a more formal appearance, but may be harder to read if not properly set.



Kerning

The manual or automatic manipulation of inter-character spacing to achieve more aesthetically pleasing visual spacing an appearance of text. While machine set type may be 'mechanically' correct, undesirable spacing may result from the combination of particular characters, the act of kerning is the adjustment procedure for preferable, more pleasing, visual spacing. Kerning usually means a reduction of inter-character spacing, but in some case spacing may also be added. Overall white space reduction (Tracking), the act of reducing space between every character by a uniform amount, should not be confused with kerning. The automatically applied kerning by software publishing programs is based on tables of values built into the font. Some programs also allow manual kerning to make fine adjustments. Adjustments in kerning are especially important in large display and headline text lines. Also see Letterspacing.

Keyboard Layout, Keyboard Mapping

A keyboard layout or mapping is a table used by a computer operating system to govern which character code is generated when a key or key combination is pressed. Sometimes known as a character mapping. Also see Character, Character Encoding, Glyph.



Ladder

Three or more consecutively hyphenated lines in a column, considered typographically undesirable.

Layout

A designer's sketch of a finished job, showing the type, and all other elements such as illustrations, photos and colour.

Leading

The spacing between lines of type and/or other elements within a column, it is usually expressed in points (72 pts per inch).

Ligature

Two or more letters combined into a single letterform. In some typefaces, character combinations such as fi and fl overlap, resulting in an unsightly shape. The fi and fl ligatures were designed to improve the appearance of these characters. Letter combinations such as ff, ffi, and ffl are available in some expert set fonts and in most OpenType Pro fonts. OpenType fonts may also have other ligatures designed to improve appearance of other letter combinations (such as Th) or for artistic effect, e.g. fi, fl, ff.

Live Matter

Typeset data or material still having potential for reproduction whereas dead matter would have no further use.

Lowercase (l.c. or lc)

1. The 'small' letters as opposed to the capitals and small capitals.
2. The non-capitalized letters in the alphabet.

Latin Alphabet

An ancestor of our current alphabet consists of twenty-one letters, excluding j, u, w, y, and z. It is the parent alphabet of western European languages, including German Fraktur, Old English, and uncial forms of letters. 'Latin' is also used to distinguish this alphabet from non-Latin scripts such as Greek, Cyrillic, Hebrew, Arabic, etc.

Letterspacing

Extra space added between individual characters. Mechanical Letterspacing is the addition of the same amount of space between each character. Optical Letterspacing is the insertion of varied amounts of spacing between characters in order to achieve an optical 'evenness' of spacing on a line.

Lightface

A term used for those typefaces having a lighter weight or thinner strokes than their 'normal weight' counterparts with little or no reduction in the character widths.

Line Length

The length or width of a line of type generally measured in picas and points. Also called 'measure'.

Logotype

A corporate or organizational trademark or symbol usually called a 'logo'.



Margin

The white space surrounding the image area where image and text exist on a page. Margins between columns of type are called gutters.

Measure

Line length. Usually expressed in points and picas and so entered as an instruction to the computer.

Misprint

1. A typographical error usually attributed to the author.
2. Any erroneous printed information.

Modification

Generally refers to the distortion in one dimension of an image while maintaining the other, such as expanding a typeface while maintaining the original height. Modifications also include the arcing or curving of a baseline, the creation of an outline or inline, shadow, or creating a perspective effect.



Numerals, Non-aligning

Figures which vary in height above the baseline and which may have descending elements, e.g. 56789. Also called text figures, they are intended primarily for use with lowercase letters. See Figures.

Markup

Instructions added to the manuscript which, when executed by the typesetter, will result in the type being set in the desired style, size, and format.

Measurement

In North America, the typographer's basic unit of measurement is picas and points. The em and en are also common units of measurement having a relative value to the point size being used, i.e. an em in 12-point type is 12 points wide; an en is half that size, or 6 points wide.

Mixed

Type having a mix of different sizes and/or styles within the same line or block of text.

Multiple Master

An older Adobe Postscript technology that allowed the user to interpolate or extrapolate certain predetermined font elements, such as width or weight or optical adjustments, in order to better fit within the typesetting. The Multiple Master technology was discontinued in the late 1990s due to shoddy typesetting application adoption and user confusion.

Numerals, Aligning

Figures which are all of the same height, base-aligned, and with no descending elements, e.g. 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 0. Also called lining or ranging figures. See Figures.

Number Sign

Typographic symbol (#) used for numbers or pound or to refer to an unnumbered footnote. In proofreading it is used to indicate space. Also called "hatch marks".



Oblique

Usually refers to a typeface that has been electronically slanted or sloped to make a faux *Italic*. Some typefaces have drawn obliques e.g. *Cantarell Oblique*.

O. K. with Corrections (or Changes)

A notation that usually accompanies the handwritten initials of a person authorized to sign indicating that a laserproof or a press proof has been approved by the client, provided the specified corrections (or changes) are accurately made.

Open Face Type

Commonly called 'outline' type, in which the typeset character prints as an outlined shape rather than a solid image.

Open Quote

A mark (") of punctuation denoting the beginning of a quotation. The two forms are double open quote (") and single open quote (').

Optical Size

A specific typeface design that is tailored for the point size it is to be used at. Several of OpenType fonts include four optical size variations—caption, regular, subhead, and display—that have been optimized for use at specific point sizes. Although the exact intended sizes vary by family, the general size ranges include: caption (6 – 8 point), regular (9 – 13 point), subhead (14 – 24 point), and display (25 – 72 point).

Overhang

Any type or image extending beyond the primary margins of main text, on one or both sides.

O. K.

A notation used to indicate that a proof is correct and has no errors or pending changes.

Oldstyle Figures

See Numerals, Non-aligning.

OpenType

A cross-platform font file format developed by Adobe and Microsoft. OpenType is an extension to the TrueType file format that can now support PostScript font data and new typographic features. Based on Unicode, OpenType fonts may include an expanded character set and layout features to provide richer linguistic support and advanced typographic control. Feature-rich Adobe OpenType fonts are distinguished by the word *Pro*, which is part of the font name and appears in application font menus. OpenType fonts can be installed and used alongside PostScript Type 1 and TrueType fonts. Also see Unicode, TrueType, PostScript Type 1.

Operator

The person who operates a keyboard.

Orphan

The first line of a paragraph that is also the last line on a page, generally considered poor typography. Sometimes the last line of a paragraph that is also the first line of a new page is referred to as an orphan.

Output Device

Any device used to produce the final product of a database such as a laserwriter or typesetter.



Pagination

1. The process of page make-up.
2. The numbering of pages with associated running heads and feet, including possibly trim marks.
3. The breaking down of a file or galley into individual pages.

Paragraph Mark

A mark (¶) indicating the beginning of a new paragraph. Also called a pilcrow.

PE. Printer's Error(s).

An acronym for any typographical errors found in typeset copy not originating with the customer or author—to be corrected at the designer or typesetter's expense.

PFM File

The portion of a Windows PostScript Type 1 font that contains the bitmapped screen fonts and metrics information—that is, character-width data.

Pi (Pronounced 'pie')

Pi characters are unique or special characters such as math symbols, bullets, daggers, boxes, arrows, etc., not always part of the primary font. They may be designed for use with specific typefaces or generically designed for use with any face.

Picture Font

A font that displays pictures or symbols instead of letter forms or characters. Picture fonts are useful for making logos, borders or interesting bullets. Like clip art, they can also be used as graphic raw material in some graphics software packages, such as Adobe Photoshop® or Adobe Illustrator.® Also known as pi fonts, symbol fonts, and dingbats.

Paragraph

A visually defined grammatical element of text having one subject or speaker. It may include more than one sentence and be identified by line space separation, indents or other subjective design specifications.

Paragraph Rule

A continuous vertical or horizontal line, the weight or thickness of which is usually specified in points or fractions of a point.

Penalty Copy

A manuscript or copy presented in such a way as to make the typesetting unusually difficult or time consuming, demanding a premium charge or penalty by the typesetter. Examples of penalty copy would include illegible or poorly handwritten manuscript, barely readable photocopies, or copy to be set in a very complex format.

PFB File

The portion of a Windows PostScript Type 1 font that contains the font's character outline information and the b stands for binary.

Pica (pronounced 'pie-ka')

A unit of measurement comprised of 12 points or approximately 1/6 of an inch—.1662 inches to be exact. Commonly used with points in defining widths, i.e. 20 picas, 6 points wide.

Pi Font

Any font containing an assortment of special characters, such as symbols or accents, which are not included in the normal alpha-numeric character set that makes up a regular font, e.g. □ ☞ ™ ∞ (Wingdings)

Point

1. The basic typographic unit equal to 0.01383", or approximately 1/72 of an inch. In the computer era the point has been rounded off to exactly 1/72 of an inch. Twelve points equals one pica.
2. A punctuation mark; especially a period.

Point System

The system of measurement using points and picas.

PostScript Type 1

A font format designed to conform to the PostScript page description language. On Windows, PostScript Type 1 fonts consist of a PFM that contains the font's outline information and a PFM that contains the font's metrics. On the Mac OS platform, PostScript fonts were composed of screen fonts (or bitmapped fonts) and printer fonts (or outline fonts). PostScript fonts required a PostScript printer to render accurately or they were printed to a non-PostScript output device using Adobe Type Manager software. Also see PostScript font, Multiple Master.

Printer Font

One of the two components of a PostScript font for the Mac OS platform. The printer font contains mathematically defined outlines for all characters (or glyphs) in that font, and is downloaded to the printer when that font is used in a document. Also known as an outline font.

Point Size

The size of type is specified or referred to in points. In some systems the visible image is actually slightly less than the specified size, space being left around each character to prevent any overlapping, either horizontally or vertically.

PostScript

Adobe's mathematically based page description language that communicates with an output device and conveys information regarding how to create complex letter shapes and graphics. Developed by Adobe in 1985.

Preface

A preliminary element of a book containing the author's formal statement of purpose and, often the acknowledgments, unless these are long enough to get into a separate section.

Prime

The prime mark follows a number and indicates a distance amount of 'feet'. The prime mark is often used in place of the curly apostrophe in typewritten material, emails, on the Web, etc. It is a straight, upright tick mark—in some fonts it may be tapered or shaped like an upside down teardrop, e.g. '. When the prime mark is used as an apostrophe (or for single quote marks) in typeset material, it is often considered a sign of amateur or sloppy typography. Also see Double Prime.

Proportional Figures

Numerals that have different widths depending on their shape. When setting body text, it is preferable to use proportional figures. Also see tabular figures.

Proof

A print of typeset material or other graphic elements. Reading or Rough Proof: a proof, not of reproduction quality, used for approvals, or on which corrections or changes are to be marked. Galley Proof: a proof of text copy before being made into pages. Reproduction Proof: also called a 'repro proof' or 'repro'. A proof of the highest quality intended to be reproduced.



Query

A question addressed to the author, editor or designer by marking on the manuscript or typeset proof.



Ragged Left

Type that is set flush to the right margin and appears ragged on the left.

Raised Cap

A design treatment in which the first capital letter of a paragraph is set in a large point size and aligned with the baseline of the first line of text. Also see Drop Cap and Initial Cap.

Proofreader's Marks

A collection of simple, universal symbols used by proofreaders to mark any required corrections or changes on proofs.

Proofreading

The act of reading or inspecting a proof to identify errors or substandard quality.

Quotation Marks (Quotes)

Marks used to enclose quoted words, sentences or phrases in text. In the US they use double quotes outside (" ") and single quotes (' ') within a quotation. In the UK they prefer the opposite.

Ragged Right

Type that is set flush to the left margin and appears ragged on the right.

Reference Mark

A symbol, letter, or numeral that flags information and directs the reader to associated footnotes, etc.

Register Marks

Crosses within a circle, two lines perpendicular to each other or any other mark that can give a true reference point for the proper position of the image, including trimming and/or binding operations.

Revised Proof

An updated or corrected proof.

Rivers

Word spaces that align vertically from line to line in poorly justified text creating a distracting river of white space in a block of copy.

Rule

A solid or dashed graphic line in documents used to separate the elements of a page. Rules and other graphic devices should be used sparingly, and only for clarifying the function of other elements on the page.

Rough Proof

A proof printed without special care. Usually a photocopy or laserwriter proof.

Run On

The combining of two or more sentences in order to avoid beginning a new paragraph.

Reset

To re-typeset material that had previously been set.

Reverse Out

When type or a drawing appears in white on a black or coloured background it is said to be 'reversed out'. This technique makes it possible to use the paper as a second, or third colour. This technique greatly reduces legibility, especially with small type.

Roman

1. Within a typeface family, the regular version as distinguished from light, bold, italic, condensed, expanded or other variations.

2. The normal upright version, as contrasted with italic or oblique.

Rough

A crude or basic but clear sketch of a design or drawing.

Runaround

Typeset matter set to fit, or contour, around a shape or specified area.

Runover

Any typeset matter that exceeds the desired width or depth.



Sans Serif

A class of typefaces without serifs on the individual characters, e.g. He .

Screen Font

One of two components for a PostScript font on the Mac OS platform. These are created by sending electronic information to pixels (dots) on the computer screen thus allowing you to view the font on-screen. Also known as a bitmapped font.

Section Mark

The (§) character, often used as the fourth reference mark in footnote material.

Set

1. The act of setting type.
2. The width of a typeface, as in a 'wide set' face.

Shilling Stroke

The (/) character. Also called the slash, solidus, or virgule. Often incorrectly used to produce fractions, separate shillings and pence, lines of poetry when run-in, and for other purposes.

Specimen Page

1. A type foundries sample showing of the typefaces they have available.
2. A sample page typeset and made up for approval or modification.

Stet

A proofreader's term to ignore new instructions and leave the original matter unchanged.

Score

To crease a sheet of paper or board so it will fold smoothly.

Script Font

Fonts that appear to have been hand lettered with a calligraphy pen or brush, or sometimes with a pencil or technical pen. A class of typefaces that emulate various handwritten letterforms, e.g.

Serif

The short, usually perpendicular line found at the end of the stroke of a character. Serifs may vary in weight, length and shape, and contribute greatly to the style and readability of typefaces, e.g.



Set Solid

Typeset matter with no added space between lines, measured from one baseline to the next

Small Caps

Specially made capital letters reduced to the x-height in size and weight of a font. The proofreader's mark for small caps is a double underscore.

Sort

Any character in a font.

Stagger

To set type with a 'bouncing' baseline and/or erratic character spacing, etc.

Style

Typesetting standards, customs, or rules defined by the typographer or buyer for consistency. Used to determine solutions or prevent problems in hyphenation, punctuation, capitalization, etc. A 'House Style' is the standard applied by a particular company or typographer to cover those instances not clarified in client specifications.

Superior

Also called a superscript. A character, usually smaller than the main character, and set above the baseline. Commonly used in footnote references and mathematics, e.g. ^{Garamond} ATF.

Superscript

See Superior.



Tabbing

Similar to quadding but associated with tabular work as opposed to entire lines. Tabbing will end each column or tab appropriately but will not affect other tabs or terminate the current line.

Text

The main body of reading matter, as distinguished from all other elements such as headings, tables, footnotes, etc. Typefaces can be classified as either text or display, text is generally about 14 point or less.

Subhead

1. Any heading that is inferior or subordinate to one or more others.
2. Any heading not of the highest order, largest size, boldest weight, etc. within that particular piece.

Subscript

An inferior character, usually smaller than the main character and set below the baseline. Commonly used in chemistry and mathematics, e.g.

Symbol Font

A category of type in which the characters are special symbols rather than alphanumeric characters.

Table

Tabular material consisting of rows and columns within the overall width or measure. Tables may or may not have vertical or horizontal rules. Tables commonly have headings across the top of each column and sometimes in the far right column, for identification or classification.

Tabular figures

Numerals that all have the same width. This makes it easier to set tabular matter. Most fonts have tabular figures. Also see Proportional Figures.

Text fonts

Text fonts are used for body copy and are most commonly serif fonts. In large families of typefaces these are often denoted with the suffixes regular or book (for example, Utopia Regular or Gibson Book).

Tracking

Adjusting the average distance between letters in a block of text. Generally, large type requires proportionally less space between letters to appear subjectively right visually while small type requires more letter spacing to appear right. Also see letterspacing.

Type Family

That group of typefaces comprised of variants derived from one basic design. They may include italic, bold, bold italic and other variations of weight as well as condensed and expanded versions. See Family.

Type Library

The entire collection of individual typefaces owned by a designer or available from a typographer or font manufacturer.

Typesetting

1. The act of setting type by any method.
2. The final step or machine process of outputting typeset material from keyboarded data.

Typo

A shortened expression for any typesetting error. An error typed into the original copy or keyboarded into the typeset material.

Tilde

The (ñ) accent. In Spanish it refers to the complete character, not just the accent.

True Type

An outline font technology developed by Apple Computer.

Type

See PostScript Type 1.

Typeface

The letters, numbers, and symbols that make up a design of type. A typeface is often part of a type family of coordinated designs. The individual typefaces are named after the family and are also specified with a designation, such as italic, bold, or condensed. For example, the *italic* style of the Times family is referred to as a typeface or font. See Face.

Type Style

1. A class of typefaces. There are various ways of grouping typefaces by classification, including; Old Style (e.g. Garamond), Modern (e.g. Helvetica), Transitional (e.g. Baskerville), Decorative (e.g.  Bodoni Ornaments), Egyptian (e.g. Roboto Slab), Blackletter (e.g. **Arial Black**), Script (e.g. *Brush Script* *Mt*), Sans Serif (e.g. **Stevie Sans**), and many others.
2. Analogous to typeface name.
3. The specific variation within a family.

Typographer

Traditionally, and correctly, a person skilled in the selection and arrangement of type in a manner that is aesthetically pleasing and suitable for the intended purpose. This implies experienced judgment, creative abilities and considerable technical knowledge. Frequently misused as a synonym for typesetter. A typographer may design and specify work to be typeset without necessarily setting the type, whereas a typesetter, by definition, sets type, but is not necessarily involved in the creative process and is usually following another's instructions.

Typography

1. The act, or art and craft, of assembling individual characters and images into an acceptable form suitable for printing.
2. The printed image composed of typeset matter.

Umlaut

The (¨) accent used in German and certain other foreign languages.

Unicode

An international double-byte character encoding standard that encompasses virtually all of the world's languages. Supported by many of the leading hardware and software manufacturers, Unicode assigns a unique value to each of the characters (or glyphs) in all of the world's languages.

Typographic Color

The apparent blackness of a block of text. Color is a function of the relative thickness of the strokes that make up the characters in a font, as well as the width, point size, and leading used for setting the text block.

Typographic Design

Pertains to the aesthetic contributions made by the relative placement of typeset matter and its specifications of size, style, leading, etc. on the overall appearance of a printed piece.



Underscore

1. A rule typeset below a character or series of characters or words.
2. On original manuscript or hard copy, a proofreader's mark identifying copy to be set in italic.

Unjustified

Depending on alignment, this term refers to text that is set flush left, flush right, or centered.

Uppercase

Also called 'caps'. All the capital letters found within a font.



Variable Fonts

The variable fonts technology was introduced in 2016 to allow a single font file to contain a continuous range of design variants. Such variants may include, among other features, interpolated widths or weights, optical adjustments and genre changes. The technology itself is an advanced version of an older one called Multiple Masters, developed then discontinued by Adobe in the 1990s. Support for variable fonts is currently available in the major Adobe Creative Cloud programs and some modern web browsers. See Multiple Master.



Weight

1. The relative thickness of the strokes in a character, such as regular, semi-bold, bold, etc.
2. The thickness of a rule, e.g.



Web Fonts

These fonts can be based on the same design of their print font counterparts but there are usually differences in the design, spacing, and licensing of each. Fonts intended for use on the web are optimized and often modified to enhance readability and performance onscreen in a variety of digital environments. This can include a taller x-height (or reduced ascenders and descenders), wider letterforms, more open counters, heavier thin strokes and serifs, reduced stroke contrast, as well as modified curves and angles for some designs. Another important adjustment—especially for fonts intended for smaller sizes—is more open spacing. All of these factors serve to improve character legibility and overall readability in the non-print environment, which can include the web, ebooks, ereaders, and mobile devices.

Width

One of the possible variations of a typeface within a font family, such as condensed or extended.

Word Break or Word Division

See Hyphenation.



X Height

The vertical measurement, upwards from the baseline, of the height of those lowercase letters without ascenders or descenders, specifically: a, c, e, m, n, o, r, s, u, v, w, x, and z.

Wrong Font (WF)

Traditionally a type of different size or design from that specified or desired. In recent times WF usually denotes simply the use of the wrong typeface.

Word Space

The space between words. In unjustified setting the word space will be fixed. In justified settings the word space will vary from line to line in order to 'fill out' each line to the same length. Word space is measured in 'units' determined by the style and size of typeface used.

White Space

Generally refers to those areas within a page not having a printed image. The blank areas on a page where text and illustrations are not printed should be considered an important graphic element in page design.